

July 17, 2026 01:15 PM GMT

Greater China Materials | Asia Pacific

Weekly Monitor: Energy Storage Continues to Support Lithium Battery Demand

Key Takeaways

- China unveils draft rules for long-term energy supply contracts, emphasizing "base price+floating price" mechanism for port-based contracts.
- Qinyuan County currently has two resumed coal mines, with a total approved capacity of 3.6 million tons.
- Planned lithium battery production in July reached a record high, with energy storage accounting for over 40% of demand.
- DRC president ordered state revenue agencies to refrain from heavy-handed enforcement operations against mining companies.
- Indonesia refuses to grant a comprehensive increase to the national nickel production quota.

Base metals: Shanghai copper prices stayed flat and inventories declined 34.9% WoW. Shanghai aluminum prices inched up 0.4% and inventories decreased 1.1% compared to a week ago.

Battery metals: Domestic industrial- and battery-grade hydroxide prices decreased 5.6% WoW and 5.1% WoW, respectively. Industrial- and battery-grade lithium carbonate prices dropped 4.9% and 4.7% WoW, respectively.

Gold: Prices slipped 3.6% WoW, to US\$3,977/oz.

Steel: Shanghai HRC inched up 0.6% while CRC prices rose 0.1% WoW. Shanghai rebar prices edged down 0.8% while Tangshan billet prices increased 0.7% WoW. Long steel inventories at traders decreased 1.3% while those of flat steel dipped 0.9% WoW.

Cement: Prices inched up 0.1% WoW, to Rmb310/t as of July 17.

Coal: QHD5500 prices edged up 0.1% WoW, to Rmb722/t as of July 17; inventory was flattish WoW, at 6.8mnt. BSPI dipped 0.1% WoW.

Glass: Glass fiber industry average 2400tex prices remained unchanged at Rmb4,067/t. Float glass prices dipped 0.2% WoW. Solar glass 3.2mm tempered prices stayed at Rmb15.0/m².

MORGAN STANLEY ASIA LIMITED+

Rachel L Zhang

Equity Analyst

Rachel.Zhang@morganstanley.com

+852 2239-1520

Chris Jiang

Equity Analyst

Chris.Jiang@morganstanley.com

+852 3963-1593

Hannah Yang, CFA

Equity Analyst

Hannah.Yang1@morganstanley.com

+852 2239-7079

Cynthia Tang

Research Associate

Cynthia.Tang@morganstanley.com

+852 3963-4360

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Industry View

Attractive

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Exhibit 1: Price and Inventory Movements Snapshot

Steel	Price/Inventory	WoW	MoM	YoY	YTD
HR Sheet 3mm Shanghai	3,340	0.6%	-1.5%	1.5%	1.8%
CR Sheet 1mm	3,780	0.1%	-1.2%	1.5%	-0.6%
Shanghai Rebar incl. 13% VAT (Rmb/t)	3,139	-0.8%	-2.7%	-3.3%	-3.5%
Tangshan Billet incl. 13% VAT (Rmb/t)	2,990	0.7%	-1.0%	1.4%	-2.0%
Flat Steel Inventory (mnt) - as of Jul 16	6,012	-0.9%	1.7%	21.3%	37.6%
Long Steel Inventory (mnt) - as of Jul 16	5,677	-1.3%	4.9%	33.2%	76.2%
Iron ore-China import CFR (US\$/t)	100	1.0%	-1.0%	1.0%	-3.8%
GP/ton - as of Jul 17	Current	1-wk ago	1-mt ago	1-yr ago	end 2025
HRC GP/t at Spot, est.(Rmb)	(67)	(51)	5	193	9
CRC GP/t at Spot, est.(Rmb)	(106)	(78)	(41)	115	45
Rebar GP/t at Spot, est.(Rmb)	(78)	(75)	(31)	192	119
Mid-Plate GP/t at Spot, est.(Rmb)	14	37	81	208	33
Base and Precious Metals	Price/Inventory	WoW	MoM	YoY	YTD
Copper Spot (Rmb/t)	104,250	0.0%	-1.3%	33.3%	4.9%
- SHFE/LME Premium (Discount)	0.4%				
SHFE Inventory - Copper (Kt)	80	-34.9%	-57.6%	-1.9%	-45.0%
Aluminum Spot (Rmb/t)	23,220	0.4%	-2.7%	13.2%	3.4%
- SHFE/LME Premium (Discount)	-5.1%				
SHFE Inventory - Aluminum (Kt)	476	-1.1%	-9.9%	361.5%	266.9%
Zinc Spot (Rmb/t)	24,430	-1.2%	-0.5%	11.2%	5.1%
- SHFE/LME Premium (Discount)	-11.6%				
Gold (US\$/oz)	3,977	-3.6%	-6.6%	18.8%	-7.9%
Battery metals					
Industrial-grade lithium hydroxide - as of Jul 16	125,250	-5.6%	-11.8%	141.0%	101.0%
Battery-grade lithium hydroxide - as of Jul 16	137,850	-5.1%	-10.8%	140.1%	98.1%
Industrial-grade lithium carbonate - as of Jul 16	147,000	-4.9%	-11.2%	132.2%	104.7%
Battery-grade lithium carbonate- as of Jul 16	151,000	-4.7%	-10.9%	132.7%	101.2%
Coal					
China Qinhuangdao 5500kcal/kg Rmb/t	722	0.1%	-0.7%	9.7%	1.8%
Qinhuangdao port inventory (mnt)	6.80	0.0%	4.6%	21.4%	3.5%
BSP1 (Baohai Coal Index) Rmb/t	713	-0.1%	-0.1%	7.7%	1.4%
Cement					
China Cement Price (Rmb/t)	310	0.1%	-1.2%	-5.3%	-10.9%
Glass					
Glass Fiber 2400tex Price - industry average (Rmb/t) - as of Jul 16	4,067	0.0%	-2.8%	4.3%	3.4%
Float Glass Price (Rmb/t) - as of Jul 16	1,160	-0.2%	6.8%	-7.2%	-19.7%
PV Glass 3.2mm tempered (Rmb/m2) - as of Jul 16	15.0	0.0%	0.0%	-16.7%	-23.1%

Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Mysteel, CCTD, Digital Cement, UM Paper, SCI, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Prices as of July 17, 2026, except where specified otherwise.

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Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Greater China Materials

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/17/2026)
Chris Jiang		
Anhui Honglu Steel Construction (002541.SZ)	U (12/16/2025)	Rmb20.40
CGN Mining Co Ltd (1164.HK)	O (01/18/2023)	HK\$2.13
Chengxin Lithium Group Co. Ltd. (002240.SZ)	E (12/16/2025)	Rmb28.88
GEM Co Ltd (002340.SZ)	U (04/20/2026)	Rmb6.30
Shenzhen Kedali Industry Co Ltd (002850.SZ)	O (08/21/2023)	Rmb179.81
Sinomine Resource Group Co Ltd (002738.SZ)	O (12/16/2025)	Rmb46.55
Yongxing Special Materials Technology (002756.SZ)	E (11/25/2022)	Rmb42.54
Zhejiang Huayou Cobalt Co Ltd (603799.SS)	O (10/08/2025)	Rmb37.00
Hannah Yang, CFA		
China Hongqiao Group (1378.HK)	O (09/15/2023)	HK\$22.10
Chuangxin Industries Holdings Ltd. (2788.HK)	O (03/19/2026)	HK\$15.70
Flat Glass Group Co Ltd (6865.HK)	O (07/30/2020)	HK\$6.33
Flat Glass Group Co Ltd (601865.SS)	O (07/30/2020)	Rmb9.00
MMG Ltd (1208.HK)	O (12/16/2024)	HK\$7.16
Shandong Pharmaceutical Glass Co. Ltd. (600529.SS)	U (04/20/2026)	Rmb18.80

Shenhua Coal and Power (000933.SZ)	O (09/02/2025)	Rmb23.98
Tianshan Aluminum (002532.SZ)	E (07/08/2026)	Rmb11.99
Xinyi Glass Holding Limited (0868.HK)	U (05/14/2024)	HK\$8.77
Zhongfu Shenying Carbon Fiber Co Ltd (688295.SS)	O (08/25/2023)	Rmb38.88
Rachel L Zhang		
Aluminum Corp. of China Ltd. (601600.SS)	O (11/30/2020)	Rmb8.44
Aluminum Corp. of China Ltd. (2600.HK)	O (11/30/2020)	HK\$7.61
Baoshan Iron & Steel (600019.SS)	O (01/16/2016)	Rmb5.76
Beijing New Building Materials (000786.SZ)	O (04/09/2024)	Rmb18.53
Beijing Oriental Yuhong Waterproof Techn (002271.SZ)	E (09/25/2024)	Rmb10.74
China Jushi (600176.SS)	O (12/22/2020)	Rmb43.80
China Lesso Group Holdings Ltd (2128.HK)	U (10/08/2025)	HK\$3.86
China Steel Corp. (2002.TW)	U (12/16/2025)	NT\$18.65
CMOC Group Ltd (3993.HK)	O (09/24/2019)	HK\$15.49
CMOC Group Ltd (603993.SS)	O (06/21/2024)	Rmb17.41
CNGR Advanced Material Co., Ltd. (300919.SZ)	E (01/12/2026)	Rmb36.62
CNGR Advanced Material Co., Ltd. (2579.HK)	O (01/12/2026)	HK\$24.00
FangDa Carbon New Material Co. Ltd. (600516.SS)	U (12/16/2024)	Rmb4.97
Ganfeng Lithium Co. Ltd. (002460.SZ)	O (04/20/2026)	Rmb48.48
Ganfeng Lithium Co. Ltd. (1772.HK)	O (12/16/2025)	HK\$37.82
Henan Liliang Diamond Co. Ltd (301071.SZ)	U (04/20/2026)	Rmb62.90
Jiangsu Dingsheng New Materials (603876.SS)	U (04/20/2026)	Rmb19.35
Jiangxi Copper (0358.HK)	O (10/08/2025)	HK\$30.58
Jiangxi Copper (600362.SS)	O (10/08/2025)	Rmb39.03
JL Mag Rare-Earth Co. Ltd (6680.HK)	O (04/23/2025)	HK\$16.42
JL Mag Rare-Earth Co. Ltd (300748.SZ)	O (04/23/2025)	Rmb25.16
Nine Dragons Paper (2689.HK)	E (01/04/2023)	HK\$7.21
Shandong Gold Mining Co. Ltd (600547.SS)	E (07/09/2026)	Rmb23.76
Shandong Gold Mining Co. Ltd (1787.HK)	E (07/09/2026)	HK\$17.15
Shandong Nanshan Aluminium Co. (600219.SS)	E (07/08/2026)	Rmb3.98
Tianqi Lithium Industries Inc. (9696.HK)	O (12/16/2025)	HK\$32.46
Tianqi Lithium Industries Inc. (002466.SZ)	O (04/20/2026)	Rmb46.99
Weixing New Building Materials (002372.SZ)	U (10/08/2025)	Rmb7.79
Zhaojin Mining Industry (1818.HK)	E (07/09/2026)	HK\$17.52
Zijin Gold International (2259.HK)	O (11/06/2025)	HK\$96.50
Zijin Mining Group (2899.HK)	O (11/06/2025)	HK\$29.38
Zijin Mining Group (601899.SS)	O (11/06/2025)	Rmb28.36

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.